Antoine Holmes, Thomas Brown, Daniel Gonzalez, Jose Mora-Rodriguez, Triston Passmore, Colin McDaniel, Nolan Woodyer, Ethan Suter

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Game Production Project 2

Game Design Document

"Saddle Skedaddle"

Bottom Text Studios©

Introduction

Welcome to “Saddle Skedaddle!” This game is a prototype in which you are a yellowbellied cowboy who runs from a duel in a small Western town. While running away, your duel partner and various hazards will impede your path to your horse, which is your ticket to escape. However, you’ll also need to get your saddle from the Sheriff. The map is designed to have the player learn from their failures. Many things will end your attempts to escape the dusty town you find yourself in.

Enemies

Cowboy

The main and basic enemy that is constantly following the player around without stopping.

Mutable Variables:

Speed - sets the starting speed of the enemy

Reload Time- Specific to the Cowboy. Sets the time it takes to reload the gun once the enemy runs out of bullets. The Cowboy will be frozen during this time.

Shooting buffer - How long before the enemy can shoot again.

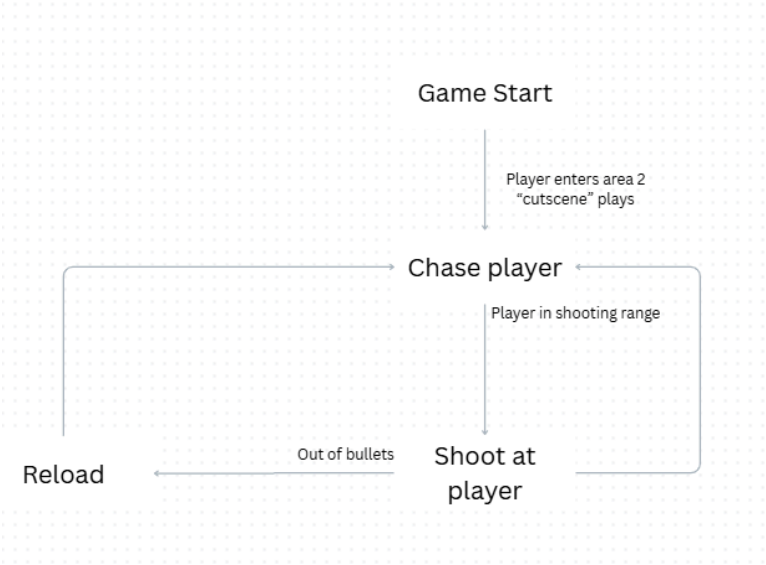
Shooting range - The range the Cowboy can shoot the player at.

Shoot Spread Time - How long the space between each shot in the volley should take.

AI logic:

Using the NavMesh and NavMesh Agent components, the enemy will constantly keep a track of where the player's position is and follow them based on the NavMesh. When the cowboy gets close enough to the player, they will shoot a bullet, (most likely make a prefab bullet and have it go towards aimed position as raycast will almost always hit). If the player is shot then game over. The gun will be a six shooter so he has six shots before reload. When reloading he stands still.

Cowboy Flowchart



Sheriff

The Sheriff around these parts takes no liking to strangers in his town, especially one that's causing a ruckus. Once the player enters the Stable and is directed to the Sheriff's Shed to find a saddle, the Sheriff becomes active and begins patrolling the middle-right side of the map. If the Sheriff catches the player, they will lose the game.

Mutable Variables:

Patrol speed: The speed which he patrols

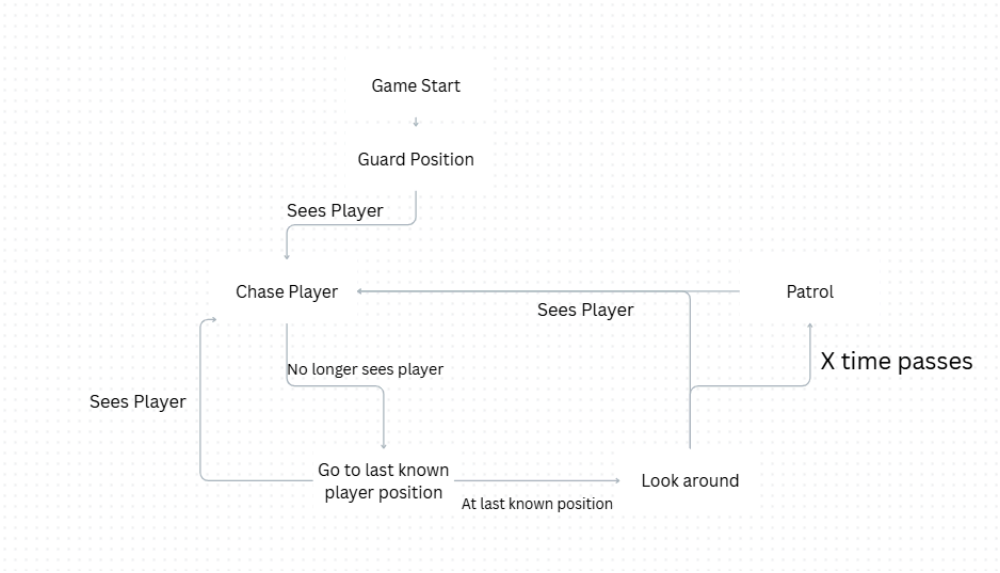
Chase speed: The speed which he chases

Wait

AI Logic:

Similar to that of the Cowboy, except the Sheriff does not constantly keep track of the player's position, instead having a line of sight. If the player is in the Sheriff's line of sight, he will chase the player until the player evades him. When the player leaves the Sheriff's line of sight, he will still run towards the player's last known position in an attempt to find the player again. If the Sheriff is active but does not see the player, he will randomly go to certain spots in the area to search. These spots will be predetermined with waypoints, but will be randomly selected. The Sheriff cannot go to the same place twice in a row and if possible should not return to previous positions (keep a list of ~3. When there are more than 3 delete index 0) for a while. While on patrol the sheriff should walk slower than the chase.

Sheriff Flowchart



Tornado

The tornado will come in after about 90 seconds to enter the map, and when it does it has a set path. If the player gets too close it will start trying to pull it in. If the player touches the tornado they lose.

Mutable Variables:

- Move Speed: How fast the tornado moves when in the map
- Pull Intensity: How strong the tornado pulls the player (Higher than you would think.
- Pull radius: Reach of the tornado's force.

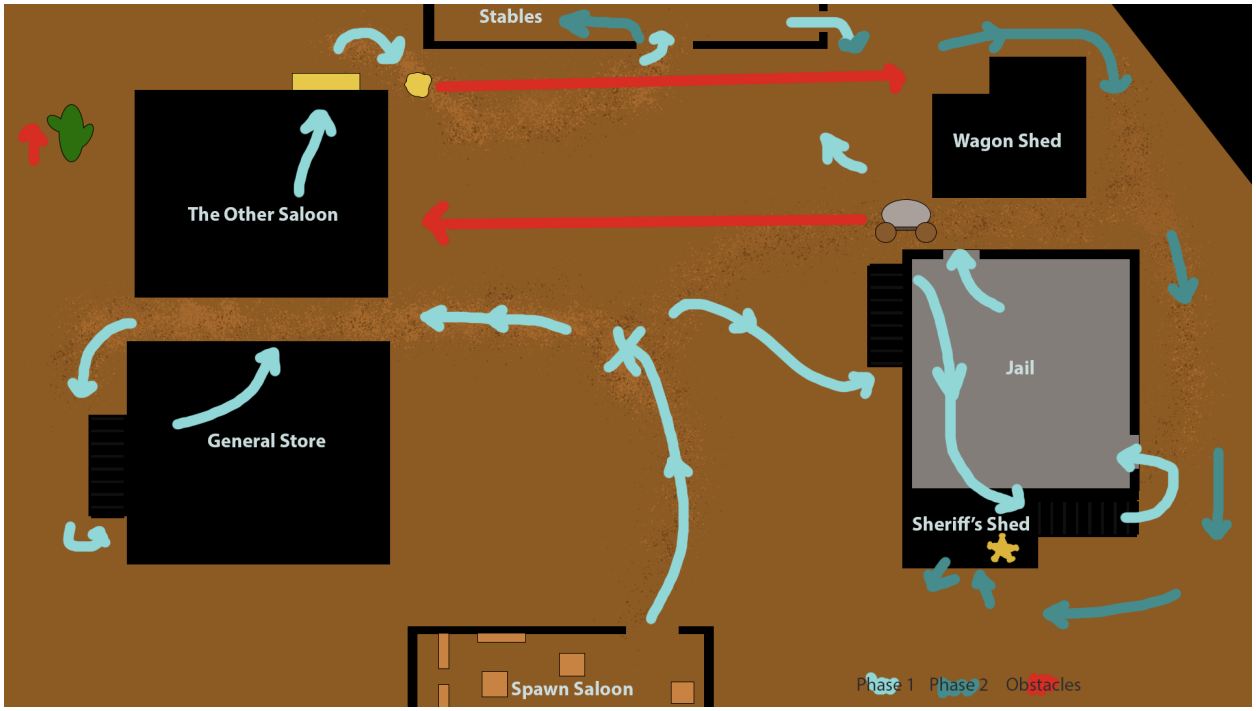
Horse Carriage:

The horse carriage is another obstacle, barging in from the right if the player runs too far forward and bash into the player if they’re not careful. Like everything else in Saddle Skedaddle, its an instant game over.

Barrels:

A bar to the far left, next to the stables has some serious wild west drama happening, a huge fight breaks out and barrels get flown from the window.

Map



A map showcasing possible player routes for each Gameplay Phase as well as Obstacle appearance paths.

Areas

Area 1:

A simple Spawn set inside a bar, with a cue to the player to meet the Cowboy outside for their High Noon Duel.

Area 2:

The main Town Square, where the player will attempt to escape the Cowboy. During Phase 2, triggered by reaching the Stables in Area 3, the Sheriff will begin his patrol. Multiple waypoints are placed around the middle-right half of the map for the Sheriff to search.

Area 3:

The Stables on the edge of town. Escape requires a saddle, which requires the player to return to Area 2 once more to steal one from the Sheriff's Shed. The player will now have to evade the Cowboy and the Sheriff and return to Area 3 with the stolen saddle.

The Horse: The Exit in the game, in order to access it the player must find the Saddle, which allows you to go near the horse and complete the level

Character Design

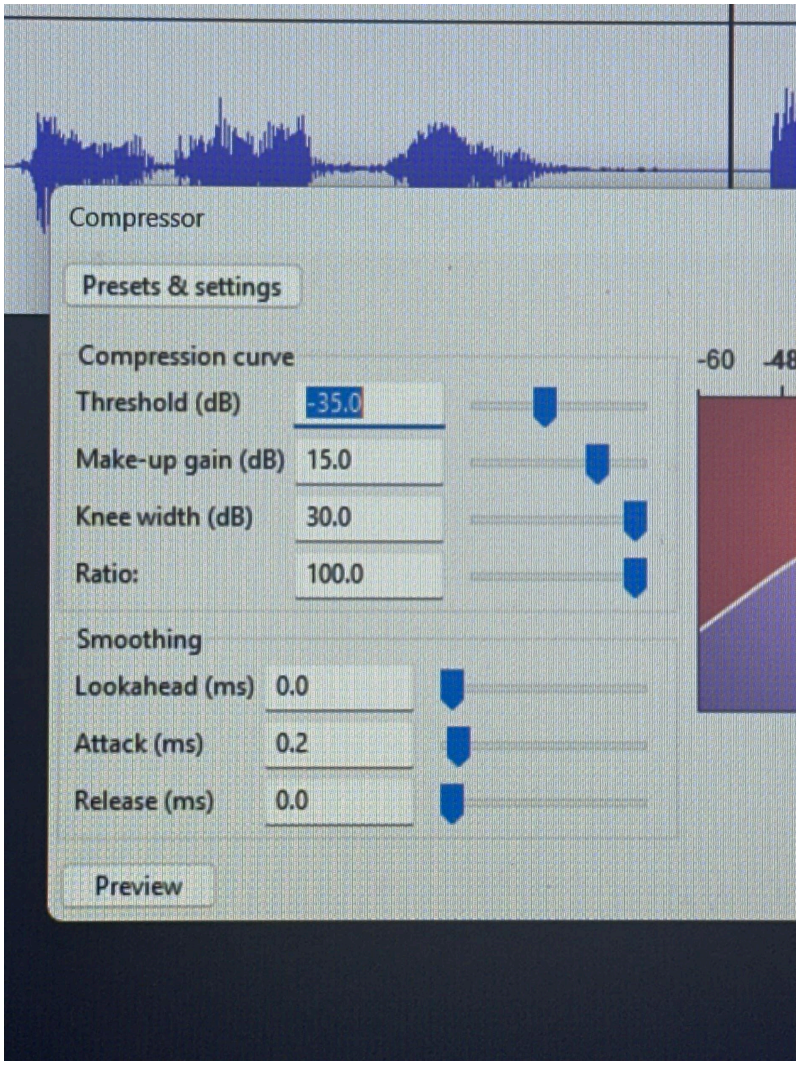
Design Principles

“Saddle Skedaddle” leans into the environment of a rough around the edges, crusty Western town. Reminiscent of low poly Playstation 1 games, the game blends pixelated 3D models with 2D sprites for characters. Proportions for characters are kept loosely realistic. They wear garb typical of the era, and are animated choppily, which contributes to the “old school” aesthetic of the game. Below is a sprite sheet for the “Sheriff” enemy type. The Sheriff is initially idly snoring, then jumps to attention when the player gets within range.

Audio Design

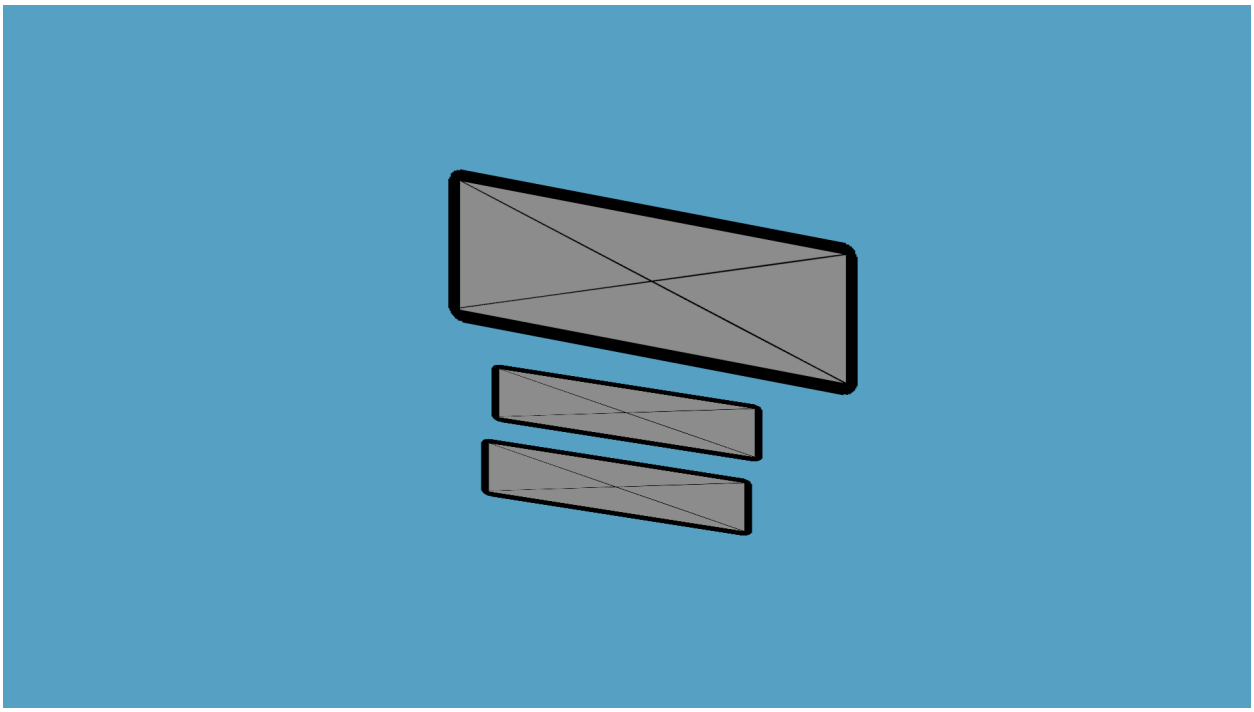
“Saddle Skedaddle” has the vibe of a crunchy PS1 game, and the sound is meant to replicate that effect, albeit pretty strongly and over the top audio crunch to sell the aesthetic of the game.

The effects include resampling the audio to 8000, and compressing it to these settings in the app Audacity

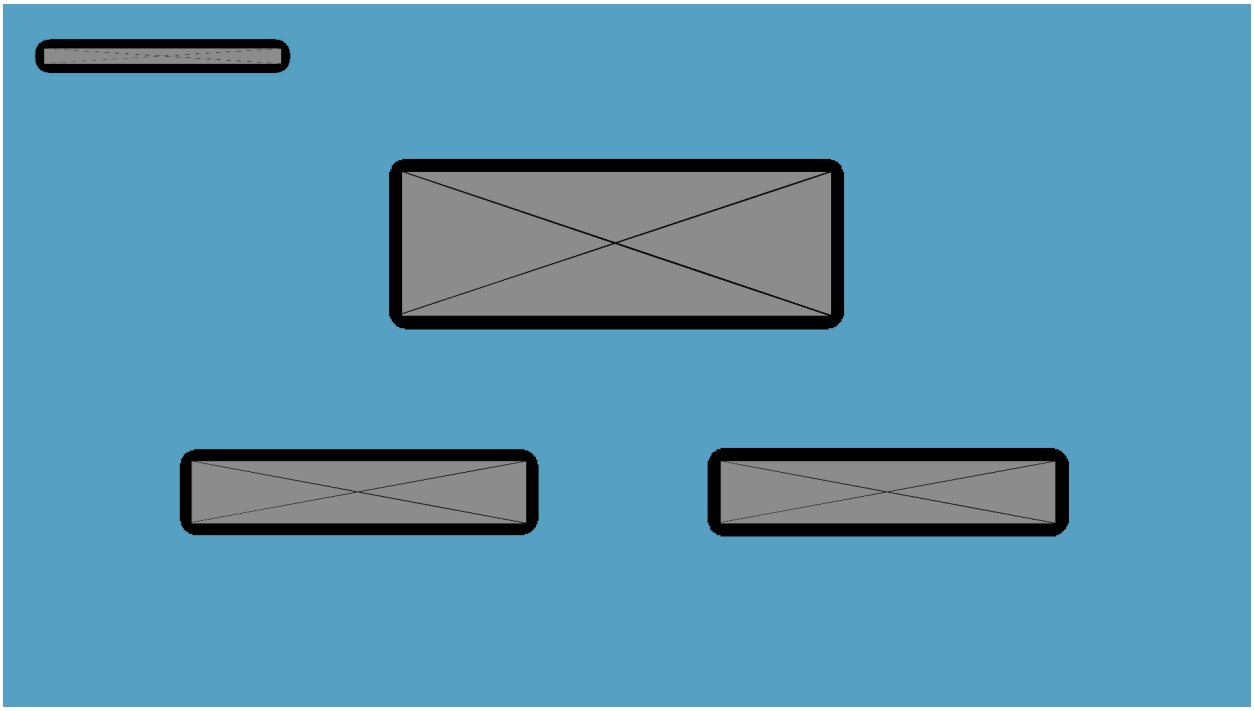


Wireframes

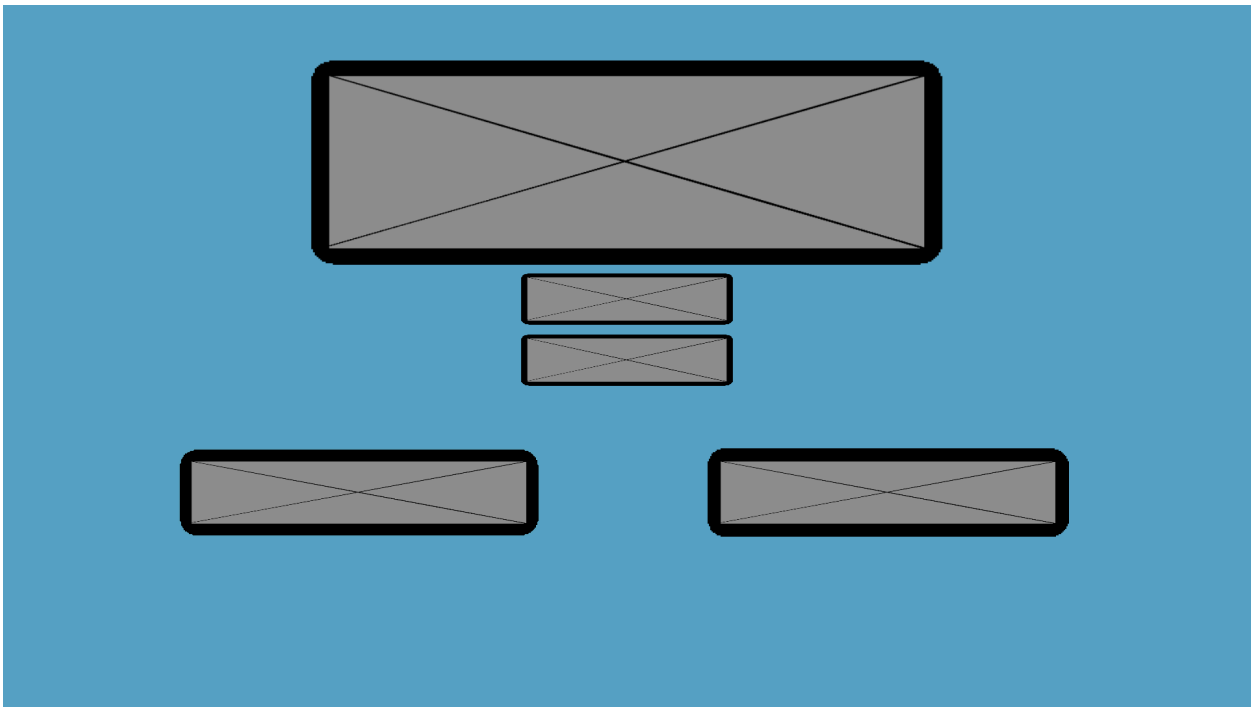
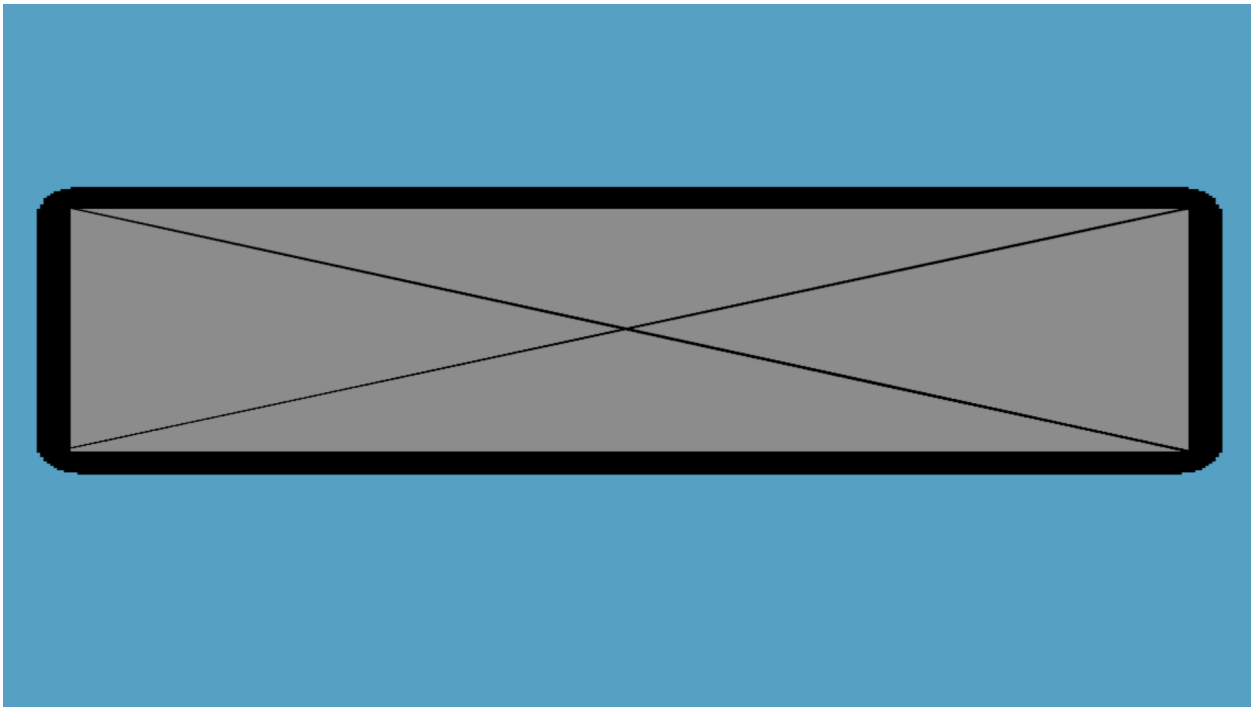
Main Menu:



Pause Menu:



Game Over:



Win: